



YOU ARE **25 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

100 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

With fingers held up to the cheek, eyes closed, and the ear just visible in the background, this image shows a very peaceful baby. To the left, the umbilical cord is visible on its way to the placenta, seen further to the left.

“ It will be some years before you’ll know your child’s personality, but even in the uterus your baby has some likes and dislikes. ”

As your baby continues to grow you may find yourself wondering what they’re going to be like: easygoing or demanding? Funny or serious? Happy playing alone or social? Boisterous or quiet? You may believe that babies are born with their personalities already developed, or that they are born with a personality that is further shaped and developed as they grow. The nature versus nurture debate rages on and, in all likelihood, it’s a combination of the two: some aspects of your child’s personality may already be decided before birth, some may be developed later in childhood, or even adulthood.

You may already have noticed that your baby has certain likes or dislikes, for example, they may kick or move in response to loud music or to a certain genre of music, though it’s difficult to tell whether the increased movements mean your baby is enjoying it or not.

Your baby is very stimulated inside the uterus. By the third trimester, they can feel vibrations and hear not just sounds from inside your body, such as your heartbeat, but also sounds from outside, such as people talking. Your baby is aware of when you’re being active or still and you may notice a pattern of movements and more “communication” when you’re resting.

As part of their development, your baby will continue practicing for life after the birth, with breathing movements and swallowing—and they may even suck their thumb.

BUYING FOR YOUR BABY

Preparing for your baby’s arrival doesn’t have to break the bank. Here are the things that your baby needs:

Milk: if bottle-feeding, you’ll need bottles, nipples, formula, and a sterilizing system.

- **Diapers:** you’ll need to decide between disposables, reusables, or a combination of the two. Whichever type you choose, you’ll also need to use wipes.